

middle week, and the week after the horn). Then I collected the results, and the table reports the *median* percentage rise, not the average. I found that the average gave results too high because of one outlier sample.

In bull markets, I didn't see much performance difference, but spikes shorter than the average led to slightly better performance. In bear markets, I saw the same trend with short spikes outperforming, but the difference in performance is substantial.

I also tested horn spikes at least twice as tall as the average. Here the median performance in bull markets did very well, but in bear markets they underperformed shorter height spikes.

I consider the results unusual. In bull markets, the results say that short spikes are good for performance but exceptionally tall ones are even better. That sounds like a contradiction.

Lower spike. I checked performance depending on which bottom of the horn was lower than the other. In bull markets, I didn't see any performance worth remarking on, but the bear market results say that when the left spike is below the right, performance improves. The median rise, regardless of which spike is lower, is 20% in bear markets. So a lower left spike sees a slight performance improvement, but a lower right spike hurts performance.

Price difference. I computed the difference between the two horn bottoms as a percentage of the breakout price. When the difference was greater than the median 1%, the horn tended to perform better after the breakout. In other words, look for horns with uneven bottoms for the best performance. That's especially helpful in bear markets.

I've seen this result in other double bottoms, where they outperform if the bottoms are uneven. It suggests the finding is reliable.

Experience

I haven't traded horn bottoms much, probably because I spend my life on the daily scales, not the weekly. [Figure 43.4](#) shows a trade I made in Michaels Stores (MIK) during the 2000 to 2002 bear market, on the weekly scale.